

SMAARTHire

What It Is, How It Works & Where It's Going

A plain-English summary of all 13 planning documents • June 2026

1. What Is SMAARTHire?

SMAARTHire is a hiring platform built specifically for Indian colleges and universities. It connects students looking for jobs with companies looking to hire — but with a twist that makes it different from regular job boards like Naukri or LinkedIn.

The Big Idea

SMAART already measures how employable students are (using something called a Skills Passport and SRI score). SMAARTHire takes that verified data and uses it to match students with the right jobs — so employers don't have to guess, and students don't send CVs into a black hole.

Think of it like this:

- A student completes their learning on SMAART and builds a verified Skills Passport
- SMAARTHire uses that passport to match them with real job openings
- Employers see only candidates who actually fit their requirements
- Placement officers at colleges can track everything and generate reports for accreditation

2. Who Uses It?

There are four types of users, each with a different experience:

User	What they do on SMAARTHire	Why it matters to them
Students	Browse jobs, apply, track applications, attend fairs	Get matched to real opportunities based on verified skills
Recruiters	Post jobs, search candidates, schedule interviews, make offers	Find the right people faster without sifting through bad CVs
Placement Officers (POs)	Oversee their college's activity, run campus drives, generate reports	Show accreditation bodies real placement data

SMAART Admins	Manage the whole platform, approve employers, handle disputes	Keep the platform running and trustworthy
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3. What Can It Do? (The 9 Core Features)

Year 1 (the first version being built) has 9 core capabilities:

- **Employers post jobs with required skills, location, salary range, and eligibility criteria.** Job Posting
- **Students browse and get matched to relevant jobs based on their Skills Passport.** Candidate Discovery
- **Students apply with one click — their verified profile is the application.** Job Applications
- **Recruiters search for candidates using filters (skills, SRI score, institution, etc.).** Candidate Search
- **The full pipeline: shortlist → interview → offer → accept/decline, all tracked in one place.** Hiring Workflow
- **Book slots, send invites, manage reschedules — without email chaos.** Interview Scheduling
- **Create, send, and track offer letters digitally. Students accept or decline in the platform.** Offer Generation
- **Jobs can be open to all SMAART students (Tier 1) or private to one institution only (Tier 2).** Two Visibility Tiers
- **Run full placement events — single-employer drives, multi-employer fairs, virtual fairs, and pool campus drives.** Job Fairs & Campus Drives

4. Job Fairs & Campus Drives (A Big Deal)

This is a major feature because campus drives are how Indian placements actually work. The platform supports 5 event types:

- **One company visits one college — the classic Indian placement format.** Single-employer campus drive
- **Multiple companies at one venue; students visit different 'booths'.** Multi-employer job fair
- **Online version of above (Year 1: up to 200 students; Year 2: 1,000+).** Virtual job fair
- **Themed events (e.g. fintech, healthcare) across multiple colleges.** Industry-specific career fair
- **Multiple colleges send students to one shared event — common in Tier-2/3 cities.** Pool campus drive

Every event follows the same 8-phase lifecycle:

#	Phase	What Happens
1	Planning	PO creates the event, sets dates, eligibility, venue. Not visible yet.

2	Employer Onboarding	Companies confirm participation, provide roles and schedules.
3	Student Announcement	Event goes live — students can see details and show interest.
4	Registration	Students RSVP and pick which employers they want to meet.
5	Preparation	Pre-placement talks, schedule generation, final attendee lists locked.
6	Event Live	Check-ins, interviews, on-the-spot offers. Real-time updates.
7	Wrap-Up	Reconcile attendance, process immediate offers (1–3 days post-event).
8	Outcomes	Final stats, feedback, reports for accreditation submissions.

5. How It's Built (The Tech)

SMAARTHire uses the exact same technology as the existing SMAART platform — intentionally, so teams don't have to learn new tools:

Layer	Technology	What It Does
Backend language	Python + FastAPI	Handles all business logic and API requests
Database	PostgreSQL	Stores all data — users, jobs, applications, events
Cache & Queues	Redis	Speeds things up, handles background jobs
Frontend	Next.js + React + TypeScript	What users see in their browser
Styling	Tailwind CSS + shadcn/ui	Consistent look and feel
Cloud hosting	AWS Mumbai (India region)	Data stays in India for compliance
File storage	AWS S3	CVs, offer letters, profile photos
Background tasks	Celery	Emails, bulk operations, report generation

Architecture approach (Year 1)

It's built as a 'modular monolith' — meaning one application with clearly separated sections. This is simpler to build and run in Year 1. In Years 2–3, busy sections can be split off into independent services if needed. No premature complexity.

6. Data, Privacy & Compliance

Because SMAARTHire handles personal data of students and job seekers, it's built to comply with India's DPDPA (Digital Personal Data Protection Act 2023). Key principles:

- **Students must explicitly consent before their data is shared with employers.** Consent first
- **All servers are in AWS Mumbai/Hyderabad.** Data stays in India
- **Students can request their data be deleted.** Right to erasure
- **Every important action is logged — who did what, when, why. Immutable record.** Audit trails
- **The system can always explain why a candidate was recommended. No black-box AI.** Explainable matching

Note: A legal review by qualified counsel is required before launch. The documents are honest that engineering defaults need legal sign-off — particularly around exact retention periods and consent language.

7. The 3-Year Roadmap

Year 1 — Build the Foundation

Get the core working: job posting, applications, hiring workflow, campus drives, basic matching, and the two-tier visibility model. Focus is on reliability and getting real users on the platform.

Launch sequence:

- **Set up infrastructure, onboard first 5–10 partner institutions, configure SMAART SSO.** Phase 1 (Pre-launch)
- **~3 institutions, ~5 employers. Find and fix issues in a controlled environment.** Phase 2 (Closed Alpha)
- **~20 institutions, ~50 employers. Test at scale during a real placement season.** Phase 3 (Limited Beta)
- **Open to all SMAART partner institutions.** Phase 4 (General Availability)

Year 2 — Add Intelligence & Revenue

By Year 2, there's 12 months of real data. The platform starts getting smarter:

- **Based on what similar students actually got hired for, not just keyword matching.** Smarter job recommendations
- **Recruiters see candidates ranked by predicted fit, not just a flat list.** Smarter candidate ranking
- **No more external Zoom links — interviews happen inside the platform.** Embedded video interviews
- **Bulk operations, saved searches, ATS-grade recruiter tools.** Advanced search
- **Employer subscription tiers, pay-per-hire options, premium analytics products.** Revenue model
- **"SQL demand in finance roles is up 35%" — shown to students and institutions.** Skill demand forecasting

Important principle for Year 2 AI

Every recommendation or ranking change must be explainable in plain English. 'This candidate ranks higher because...' — always. No black-box outputs. This is both an ethical and commercial decision — recruiters won't trust what they can't understand.

Year 3 — Scale & Category Leadership

By Year 3 (if execution goes well):

- 150–300 partner institutions across India
- 500–1,000 verified active employers
- 100,000–300,000 confirmed hires accumulated across Years 1–2
- International expansion begins (Bangladesh, Sri Lanka, Indonesia, Philippines — 1–2 markets)
- **Alumni, mid-career professionals, continuous learners — not just fresh graduates.** Career-long platform
- **SMAART teams take on managed hiring engagements for clients who want hands-on help.** Recruitment-as-a-Service
- **Forecast whether a candidate will succeed in a role; predict where demand will be in 18 months.** Predictive intelligence

Year 3 is honestly acknowledged in the documents as speculative — priorities will be set based on what's actually learned in Years 1 and 2.

8. How the 13 Documents Fit Together

The 13 documents form a complete developer handoff suite. Here's what each one covers:

Doc	Title	What it covers
Doc 1 v2	Year 1 Functional Spec	What we're building and why. All 9 features. All user types. Full job fairs spec. (v2 added campus drives as first-class feature)
Doc 2	Year 2 Vision	Strategic direction for Year 2 — intelligence, productivity, embedded comms, revenue.
Doc 3	Year 3 Vision	Long-term ambition — category leadership, international expansion, career-long platform.
Doc 4 v2	System Architecture	The tech blueprint. Stack, modules, infrastructure, security, multi-tenancy. (v2 corrected 23 errors found in audit)
Doc 4A	Architecture Audit	Honest record of 23 issues found in Doc 4 v1. Shows what was wrong and why it was fixed.
Doc 5	Database Schema	Every table, column, and relationship. The data foundation everything else builds on.
Doc 6	API Specification Part 1	Every API endpoint — what it does, who can call it, what events it fires.
Doc 7	API Specification Part 2	Detailed request/response schemas for complex endpoints (job creation, fair lifecycle, etc.).

Doc 8	Frontend Screens Part 1	Every screen in the app — purpose, which API endpoints it uses, key elements.
Doc 9	Frontend Screens Part 2	Detailed component breakdown for the 7 most complex screens.
Doc 10	Business Rules	The logic layer — state machines, validation rules, error codes, anti-gaming rules.
Doc 11	Compliance & Data	DPDPA compliance design, data retention, user rights (erasure, access), integrations.

9. Key Things to Know (The Important Decisions)

The Skills Passport is central to everything

Every student's profile IS their Skills Passport — verified skills, SRI score, achievements. This is what makes SMAARTHire different from a normal job board. Recruiters trust it because SMAART verified it.

Two-tier visibility system

Jobs are either Tier 1 (visible to all SMAART students) or Tier 2 (private to one institution). This lets institutions bring exclusive employers that only their students can access — a big deal for partnerships.

Everything is built for India

Data stays in India (AWS Mumbai). Campus drives are first-class features. Multi-tenancy handles dozens of institutions. DPDPA compliance is built in from day one.

Modular monolith — not microservices yet

Year 1 is one application with clear internal module boundaries. This is simpler, cheaper, and faster to build. The boundaries are clean so specific modules can be extracted later if they need to scale independently.

The documents self-audit

Unusually, these documents include explicit admissions of what they don't know. Doc 4A lists 23 errors found in the architecture doc. Doc 11 tells legal counsel exactly which parts need their review. This is honest engineering.

10. Quick Glossary

Terms that come up repeatedly:

Term	What it means
Skills Passport	A student's verified profile showing skills, SRI score, courses completed, and achievements. Maintained on SMAART, used by SMAARTHire.

SRI Score	SMAART Readiness Index — a score indicating how employable a student is. Used to filter and match candidates.
PO	Placement Officer — the person at a college who manages placement activities, runs campus drives, and generates accreditation reports.
Tier 1 Job	A job visible to all SMAART students across all institutions.
Tier 2 Job	A job only visible to students from one specific institution (usually an exclusive employer relationship).
Modular Monolith	One application, but built with clear internal boundaries (modules). Easier to manage in Year 1; can be split into microservices later.
DPDPA	Digital Personal Data Protection Act 2023 — India's data privacy law, similar to Europe's GDPR. SMAARTHire is designed to comply with this.
SSO	Single Sign-On — students log into SMAARTHire using their existing SMAART account. No separate registration.
Fair / Campus Drive	A placement event where employers meet students. SMAARTHire manages the whole lifecycle from planning to outcome reporting.
ATS	Applicant Tracking System — the software recruiters use to manage hiring. SMAARTHire builds ATS-grade features for Year 2 and beyond.